WELCOME TO
LAKEWOOD VILLAGE
SUNNYVALE
Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

THE L.V.N.A.
VILLAGER

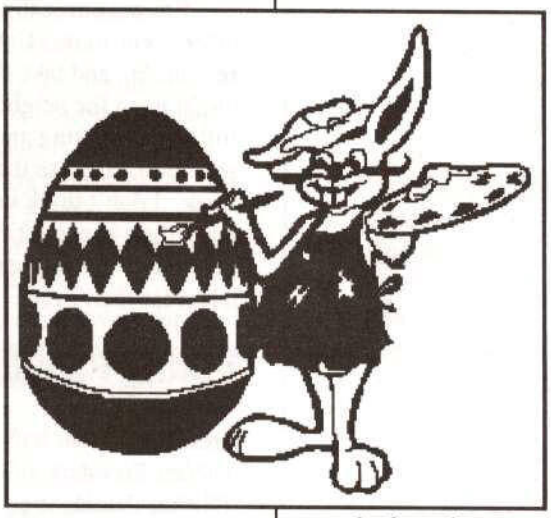
Circulation 1700

April 1996

Greetings from the President

Fred Fowler

Well folks, I guess this is where we get started... Hello! My name is Fred Fowler, and a few Wednesdays ago I was elected President of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association. Please feel free to send me your congratulations or your condolences, whichever you think would be the most appropriate. I am not sure what I have gotten myself into (and perhaps you don't know what you have gotten yourselves into, either), but time will tell. Meanwhile, I promise to do the best I can to fill this role and see that the goals of the organization are met.



Here is a little background on myself. My wife Phyllis and I moved into this neighborhood in February, 1995 -- just a little over a year ago. We found out about this place by accident. Phyllis' father works nearby and used to come to Lakewood Park to eat his lunch. He took Phyllis there one day and she was immediately taken with the area. A few months later when we were looking for a house, the Realtor showed us a nice place on Lakebird Drive, and the rest is history. Both Phyllis and I think this is one of the nicest neighborhoods in Sunnyvale, and we wouldn't want to live anywhere else.

It soon became apparent to me WHY this is one of the nicest places in Sunnyvale. Lakewood Village, like any other part of the city, is constantly besieged by problems and threats of all sorts. From crime and gangs to high-rise developments to mega-movie complexes in our back yard to indifference in city hall, there are numerous forces at work which threaten to ruin the nice little neighborhood we live in.

Shortly after we arrived we became acquainted with the LVNA. I remember the first monthly meeting I attended, and I remember shaking hands with Craig Crawford that night. Make no mistake! In my opinion, the LVNA is the reason this is one of the nicest places in Sunnyvale! It has provided a mechanism to resist all of the detrimental forces swirling around us. The tireless work of people like Craig Crawford has helped stem the tide of urban blight, and through him and others the organization has provided a voice for the neighborhood -- a voice to make our problems known to the people who have the power to mitigate them.

The LVNA is vital to the future of this little neighborhood. The issues we will have to face in the months and years to come will make the challenges of the past seem pale and insignificant. The LVNA is the ONLY mechanism we have to fight back with! We must use it well,

Continued on Page 3

Next L.V.N.A. Meeting

All residents of Lakewood Village are encouraged and invited to attend these meetings. You will meet your neighbors, learn about upcoming events of special interest to our community, have a chance to voice your concerns and opinions; and help work towards a better neighborhood. Children are welcome.

Date	Wednesday, April 10th, 1996
Time:	7:00 PM
Location:	Lakewood Park Building at Lakechime and Silverlake.
Agenda:	Ben Picard Deputy Superintendent Sunnyvale School District

Officers of the L.V.N.A.

President	Fred Fowler	747-1454
1st Vice President	Tom Freeman	734-5769
2nd Vice President	Elena Anderson	745-6028
Secretary		
Treasurer	Phyllis Fowler	747-1454
Newsletter Editor	Geoff Carter	733-0502
Ad Coordinator	Mel Anderson	745-6028

Sign Etiquette

Geoff Carter, Editor

A lot of effort is expended to control and eradicate the spurious signs placed around the neighborhood by our young people. We work so hard at it because these signs tend to be destructive in that they are usually carved into wooden fences, park and school windows, mirrors, tables, and benches or painted on any surface that strikes their fancy. These signs, by the nature of their construction tend to be of a more permanent nature and difficult to remove. Most would agree that these signs are generally a blight upon the neighborhood and quite undesirable. We have a name for these signs… graffiti.

But what of the spurious signs placed by adults? You know... the ones used to advertise "Yard Sale", "Garage Sale", and "Lost Pet" (among other things). They can be destructive in nature in that the collective effect of nails, staples, and tacks used over the years to attach these signs to the convenient wooden structures eventually turn this wood into just so much sawdust. While most of these adult-generated signs are not meant to be permanent, they are hardly ever taken down, the net effect being at least semi permanence. Most adhesives used with the various and sundry tapes used to attach signs to lamp posts and street sign posts mutate into a permanent, ugly blob after a few weeks. Are these signs, once outdated, any less of a blight upon the neighborhood than the graffiti left by our youthful offenders? I, for one, don't think so.

When the construction along Lawrence Expressway is completed we will have new signs proclaiming the identity of our neighborhood to all passers by. Will we still be able to place our signs and banners for all to see at the entrance to our neighborhood? Possibly not. Are we going to end our practice of putting up signs to advertise our events and then rely upon the elements to take the signs down? Probably not. Don't you think that these old decaying signs add one more element making our neighborhood look ugly? I, for one, do. Does it in any way diminish our quality of life? Yes.

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I'm not advocating a complete ban on "Yard Sale" and other event signs. I'm just asking that we all be a little more responsible and take down our old signs and help stem the blight upon the neighborhood. I'm also asking that we be a little more sharing and allow the space to be used by the next person to advertise their yard sale or other event the following week. I don't think its fair that one group has seen fit to leave their banner up week after week after week, and then got all bent out of shape when someone else wanted to advertise their event.

Voting Results

Ana Marie Ortega

President	Fred Fowler	33	100%
1st Vice President	Tom Freeman	28	85%
2nd Vice President	Elena Anderson	30	91%
Secretary	*Ana Marie Ortega*	1	3%
	Craig Crawford	1	3%
Treasurer	Phyllis Fowler	31	94%
	Write-in candidates		

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or else we will wake up one day in the wreckage of what was once a wonderful place to live. I will be working hard to see that that doesn't happen. I hope that all of you will do what you can to prevent it as well.

Well, so much for why the LVNA is needed... Now on to what we should try to do with it this year.

1996 GOALS

At the Election night meeting, I asked people for their opinions as to what are the most important issues we face. I got several responses, but just about everyone agreed on two of them:

1) We need to protect the safety of our children.

2) We need to support Lakewood Elementary School.

Both of these are very worthy goals. I feel these may well become central parts of our program for this year. There is one problem, though. We have to figure out HOW to do these things. The next step in the process is to determine what specific actions we can take to try to achieve these goals.

We have certain resources that we can use to achieve these goals. We have a newsletter (the one you are reading now), we have monthly meetings, we have a little bit of money (a VERY little bit), and we have the time that volunteers can give us. Whatever we do, we will have to do it with those things.

What can those tools achieve? Quite a bit, if we organize things correctly. The newsletter gives us the ability to keep all 1700 households informed as to the work we are doing and the help that is needed. The monthly meetings let us bring in organization leaders and city officials to speak and be spoken to about issues. Our little bit of money gives us the ability to put on events like the picnic last August to bring the neighborhood together. Our most precious asset, volunteer time, gives us the ability to voice our opinions in City Council meetings, to keep in touch with representatives of the Public Safety department, to keep tabs on development projects, to keep an eye on the activities around Dick's Market, and generally to make all of the pieces of the puzzle come together.

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SUPPORTING LAKEWOOD SCHOOL

There is quite a lot of good we can do if we figure out how to apply our resources to it. As a matter of fact, we have the chance to do something of great benefit to Lakewood School.

In June, there will be a ballot initiative (Measure 'A') that would be a godsend to the school if passed. It would authorize the issuance of $34 million in bonds to raise funds to repair Sunnyvale school facilities. It is a Sunnyvale School District bond, so there is NO WAY the money could be used for ANY OTHER SCHOOLS -- it will ALL be spent in Sunnyvale.

Continued on Page 4

He who laughs, lasts. *Mary Pettibone Poole*

Mrs. Lee's Challenge

Taken from the *Lakewood Lion*

School Board member and parent, Jessica Lee, has given a challenge to Lakewood School. Every class that can reach 90% regular attendance during this grading period will receive an ice cream party. Help your child come to school regularly and on time. Thanks Jessica!

Sunnyvale Schools Need Renovation

Linda Kilian (Reprinted from Last Month's Villager)

The Sunnyvale School District needs millions of dollars to renovate its schools. We're not talking about glamorous changes either. We're talking about new roofs, wiring, plumbing, dry rot, termite damage, bathroom tile, and the like.

After a year of visiting school sites, talking with administrators, and surveying the community, the Board of Education of the Sunnyvale Elementary School District placed a bond measure on the June 4th ballot. This was a difficult decision, because passing a bond measure is not easy. To win, a two-thirds majority of voters must vote in favor of the measure. One "no" vote cancels out two "yes" votes.

If passed, the bond would raise $34 million. All of this money would be spent locally on our schools. None of the money could be spent on salaries.

Lakewood School would receive up to $3.5 million to upgrade its facilities. Like most other schools in Sunnyvale, Lakewood is almost 40 years old. Time has taken its toll, and Lakewood needs a new roof, upgrades to the electrical system, repairs to rusted plumbing fixtures and pipes, a new fire alarm system, remodeled restrooms, new playground equipment, and more.

The Sunnyvale School District has been able to renovate and reopen three schools in recent years by selling a surplus school site. However, as our student population continues to grow, selling other properties is not an option. Says Sunnyvale School Superintendent Doris Wilson, "When voters understand the condition of our schools, we feel they will see this bond measure is a good thing for the schools, for the city, and for the property values of our homes."

The bond campaign organization, *Friends of Sunnyvale Schools*, is being co-chaired by Linda Kilian and Betty Verstegen. Area resident and Board member, Jessica Lee, will be organizing volunteers in the Lakewood area. If you have any questions about the bond measure or are interested in volunteering, call Friends of Sunnyvale Schools at (408) 450-1100.

Too much of a good thing can be wonderful.

Mae West

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President's Message (continued)

From what I hear, the money is sorely needed. I understand that in certain classrooms in Lakewood School, the roof leaks so badly that classes are taught in rooms with buckets catching dripping water. In Lakewood and other schools, there are health and safety related code issues that cannot be addressed without these funds. There are heating and air conditioning problems, electrical problems, plumbing problems, asbestos abatement problems -- too many problems! Measure 'A' is aimed directly at these issues, and should help make our schools places where kids can learn without worrying about how safe the building is.

As President of the LVNA, I cannot advocate a 'yes' or 'no' vote on this issue. I CAN state that I feel Measure 'A' to be of vital importance to our neighborhood, and I urge each and every one of you to study it carefully, come to a decision about it, and vote as you see fit on June 4th.

By the way, Deputy Superintendent Ben Picard of the Sunnyvale School District has asked to come to the next monthly meeting. He will be available to discuss facility needs in detail and answer any questions we have about the problems and about Measure 'A'. I ask anyone who is interested in the welfare of the school to please attend, and I look forward to seeing you there.

THE MOST IMPORTANT THINK YOU CAN DO

The LVNA is a large organization with a small core. We are 1700 households strong, but only a fraction of us have the time and/or energy to contribute in an active way. That is as it should be. (At least, that is the way it is with every other volunteer organization I have ever been associated with.)

There is something, though, that each and every one of us can do. It will be of great help to us all. It only takes a few minutes and is only needed once or twice per year. What I am talking about is asking each and every one of us to remember to VOTE. PLEASE take the time to cast your ballot in June. I don't care WHO or WHAT you vote FOR, but please DO IT.

Continued on Page 5

Regular exercise is more and more important as you grow older... you have to be in good shape to get over the hill.

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President's Message (continued)

Why do I want you to vote if I don't care what you vote for? Because POLITICIANS don't care about NEIGHBORHOODS if no one votes there. Government officials want to win elections, and if only a handful of people bother to vote in Lakewood, those officials will conclude (rightly so!) that Lakewood is far less important than a neighborhood where thousands of people vote.

Many of our problems have to do with getting officials to care about our area. It is an uphill fight as long as we don't demonstrate that WE care. We demonstrate it by voting. If we can show politicians that Lakewood has thousands of votes to fight for, I guarantee that we will get their attention in short order. And with that attention will come solutions to problems that otherwise would not be available.

Do yourself and your neighbors a favor, and vote for the issues and candidates of your choice on June 4th.

WRAPPING UP

Well, that about does it for this, the first newsletter article of my term as LVNA President. One down, eleven to go. In the meantime, I wish you all a happy spring and look forward to working with you to make Lakewood Village a better place for us all. See you at the April meeting!

Overheard on a bus: "My worry about genetically altered vegetables is that my daughter seems to be dating one."

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Leadership Team Report

Lakewood Lion

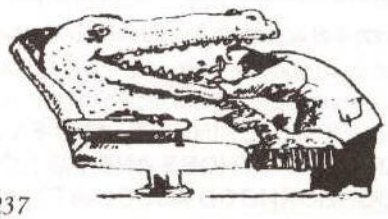
The March meeting of the School Site Council saw some changes. In an effort to become more "user friendly" and understandable, the Council is recommending a by-laws change to reflect the new name, Leadership Team. Also, the meetings will be held to one hour per month, followed by a PTO meeting. This organization is going to "break off" from the School Site Council and deal more with the issues of general concern. You are welcome to our next meeting on Tuesday, April 9th, beginning at 6:30 P.M.

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Second Quarter Honor Roll

Lakewood Lion

Congratulations to the following students for attaining honor roll status!

Greg Aarons	Melody Bracken
Ray Davis	Brittney Franklin
Nick Hawley	Mai Hoang
Milana Jordan	Peter Martinez
Khristine Madayag	Janelle Marron
Ashley Rabara	Tanya Shaw

Thanks to all these students, their families, and teachers and staff for all the hard work it took to earn this honor.

Library Fund Given to Schools

Lakewood Lion

The check-off on your California state income tax (Form 540, line 55) allows a financial donation to the California Public School Library Protection Fund. Money collected goes directly to our schools for replacing outdated library materials. In order to successfully gain our share of the money, we have created a small library committee. Next year, we'd like to begin bar coding. Won't you help by making the library tax check off when you send your taxes in?

Kindergarten Registration

Lakewood Lion

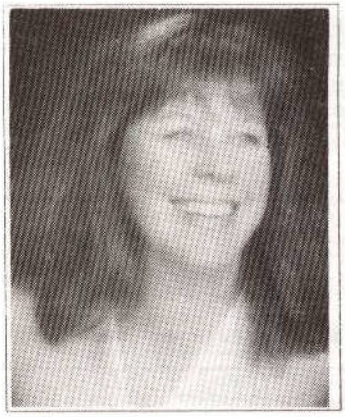
Do you know anyone in the neighborhood that has a child who will be 5 on or before December 2, 1996? Please, strongly encourage them to register their child or children so they can have a spot in our neighborhood school. Lakewood School frequently fills up all of our slots in kindergarten. When parents register their children, they must bring:

- Shot Records
- Current TB Skin Test
- Birth Certificate
- Proof of Residency

Registration begins April 1st. Please help us keep our school running smoothly by registering your incoming kindergartner from 9:00 - 11:45 A.M. and 1:30 - 3:00 P.M.

A young girl selling Girl Scout cookies was quizzed on her knowledge of the organization: "Can you recite the Girl Scout Motto?"

She thought for a moment and then answered, "Get the money before you give them the cookies."



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Newsletter Contributions

Geoff Carter, Editor

Wanted! Articles of general interest to your friends and neighbors. Do you have an idea, message, or concern that you would like to present to the neighborhood? You may submit your article(s) for the May newsletter no later than Friday, April 26th. All submissions will be considered and printed as space allows; with editing only for obvious spelling errors, grammar, and to fit within the available space (expletives cheerfully deleted). Please, don't let this newsletter become the Fred and Geoff show; your ideas and inputs are important. For further information, contact Geoff Carter at 733-0502.

Thanks to those who contributed to this month's newsletter: Linda Killian, the *Lakewood Lion*, and our new President, Fred Fowler. ☙

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